



THE APERTURE METHOD

TM

Method SOPs

Operating procedures for every segment of the Method

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Contents: Business X-Ray • Insights • Analytics • Intelligence • Compass • Atlas

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How to use this manual

This manual collects the step-by-step operating procedures for every segment of The Aperture Method in one place. Each chapter is a self-contained SOP: it states the objective, the inputs required, the deliverable produced, the step-by-step process, the tools and frameworks used, a quality checklist to run before the client readout, and the handoff to the next segment.

Run the segments in order for a full engagement — **Business X-Ray → Insights → Analytics → Intelligence → Compass → Atlas** — or run a single segment as a standalone piece of work. Every engagement is senior-led, fixed-fee, and phase-gated: the client approves continuing at each gate.

Shared standards (apply to every SOP)

- **Plain language.** Every output is explained in business terms; a person reviews every result before it reaches the client.
- **The client owns what we build.** Deliverables built on the client's data are theirs to keep.
- **Data handling.** Least-access, secure storage, no resale or reuse, de-identify where identity isn't required, and work within applicable privacy law.
- **Reconcile everything.** Every headline number ties back to the client's own source data.

01 • Business X-Ray™

The fixed-fee diagnostic front door • Diagnose “Where do we stand, and what do we fix first?”

Segment: Entry point / Aperture Insights **Deliverable:** Business X-Ray report + Aperture Score™
Typical duration: 2–3 weeks **Owner:** Senior lead (Fenwick How)

Objective

Produce a structured, seven-lens read of the whole business, name the single biggest constraint holding it back, and set an Aperture Score baseline the client can track. The X-Ray is deliberately low-risk and fast — it earns the right to a larger engagement by delivering real, prioritized insight in its first weeks.

When to run it & prerequisites

Run at the start of nearly every relationship. It is the recommended first step and the standalone wedge product. It also opens the full Method inside the Aperture Insights phase.

Inputs required

- Financial statements — P&L and balance sheet, last 3 years (and YTD).
- Basic operational data — revenue by product/service and location, headcount, capacity.
- Customer data if available — a transaction export (dates, amounts, customer IDs).
- 3–5 short interviews — owner and key managers (45 minutes each).
- Read-only access to core systems where practical (accounting, POS/CRM).

The deliverable produced

- A written Business X-Ray report — the seven-lens assessment in plain language.
- The named #1 constraint, with the evidence behind it.
- Prioritized findings: what’s working, risks & watch items, and opportunities.
- The Aperture Score — one overall health number plus a score per lens, as a baseline.
- A prescription: which Method components will move the needle, and in what order.

Step-by-step process

Step 1 — Kickoff & data request

Hold a 45–60 minute kickoff to align on goals and the one question the owner most wants answered. Issue the standard data request and secure access.

- Confirm scope, timeline, and the single success question.
- Send the data request checklist; set a data-return date.
- Set up the secure workspace and least-access credentials.

Output of this step: Signed-off scope, data request issued.

Step 2 — Assemble & sanity-check the data

Pull the data into the working model. Reconcile totals to the financials so every later number ties out.

- Reconcile revenue and margin to the P&L.
- Flag gaps or quality issues early — messy data is normal, not a blocker.

Step 3 — Run the seven-lens diagnostic

Assess each lens against the standard rubric, capturing evidence and a 1–100 score for each.

- Operations — capacity, throughput, bottlenecks.
- Finance — margin, cash, unit economics, working capital.
- Customers & retention — acquisition, repeat behavior, lifetime value.
- Processes — how work actually gets done; where it breaks.
- Technology & data — systems, data quality, automation.
- Leadership & team — key-person risk, roles, capability.
- Market & competition — position, demand, local dynamics.

Output of this step: Seven scored lenses with evidence.

Step 4 — Interviews

Run the owner and manager interviews to test the data story and surface what the numbers don't show.

- Use a consistent interview guide.
- Triangulate interview claims against the data.

Step 5 — Score & weight → Aperture Score

Combine the seven lens scores into one weighted Aperture Score using the standard rubric and weights. Record the rationale so it can be re-scored identically later.

Output of this step: Aperture Score (overall + by lens).

Step 6 — Name the binding constraint

Apply theory-of-constraints thinking: identify the one limitation that, if fixed, unlocks the most value. Everything in the prescription serves this.

Output of this step: The #1 constraint, stated plainly, with evidence.

Step 7 — Synthesis & report

Write the report: executive summary, the seven lenses, the constraint, prioritized findings, and the prescription of components.

- Lead with the answer to the owner's question.
- Every claim traceable to data or interview.
- Prescribe the next components and expected payoff.

Step 8 — Readout

Present the findings in a 60-minute session. Recommend the next step and confirm the phase-gate decision.

Output of this step: Client decision on next component(s).

Tools, analyses & frameworks

- Seven-lens diagnostic rubric (standard scoring criteria).
- Aperture Score model (weighted composite, re-scorable).
- Theory of Constraints (identify the binding constraint).
- Benchmarking against comparable businesses where data allows.
- Basic financial diagnostics — margin, unit economics, trend analysis.

Quality checklist (before readout)

- ☐ Every headline number reconciles to the client's financials.

- ☐ Each of the seven lenses has evidence, not just an opinion.
- ☐ The Aperture Score is reproducible from the recorded inputs and weights.
- ☐ The #1 constraint is singular, specific, and defensible.
- ☐ The report is readable by a non-analyst; jargon removed.
- ☐ The prescription names concrete next components and why.
- ☐ All PII handled per the data-security standard.

Readout & handoff

Deliver the report and Aperture Score, and present the prescription. If the client continues, the named constraint and prescribed components scope the next phase — hand off to the Aperture Insights SOP (to open a full engagement) or directly to the prescribed component SOP.

02 · Aperture Insights™

Understand “What is happening?” · The opening phase of a full Method engagement

Segment: 01 · Understand **Deliverable:** Business X-Ray + Aperture Score (the shared baseline)
Typical duration: 2–3 weeks **Owner:** Senior lead (Fenwick How)

Objective

Establish the shared, quantified baseline the rest of the Method builds on. Insights delivers the Business X-Ray and Aperture Score, then frames the full engagement — validating the constraint, defining success measures, and sequencing the remaining components.

When to run it & prerequisites

Run when a client engages the Method beyond a standalone X-Ray, or immediately after a standalone X-Ray converts. If the X-Ray has already been produced, do not redo it — extend it.

Inputs required

- The Business X-Ray + Aperture Score (produce it via the Business X-Ray SOP if not already done).
- Signed contract with agreed scope (Exhibit A).
- Access to the systems and data owners needed for the prescribed components.

The deliverable produced

- The Business X-Ray + Aperture Score as the engagement baseline.
- A validated statement of the #1 constraint and the success measures for the engagement.
- A sequenced plan of the components to run, with data prerequisites for each.

Step-by-step process

Step 1 — Confirm or produce the X-Ray

If a current X-Ray exists, review it with the client. If not, run the Business X-Ray SOP now.

Output of this step: Current X-Ray + Aperture Score on file.

Step 2 — Validate the constraint with the owner

Pressure-test the named constraint against the owner’s lived experience and any new data. Adjust if the evidence warrants.

- Agree the constraint in writing.
- Define what ‘solved’ looks like in numbers.

Step 3 — Define success measures

Translate the goal into 3–5 measurable outcomes that later phases (and Atlas) will track.

Output of this step: Baseline values + target ranges for each measure.

Step 4 — Sequence the components

Map the prescribed components to the constraint and order them so each hands the next what it needs.

- List the data prerequisites per component.
- Set phase-gate checkpoints and dates.

Step 5 — Readout & mobilize

Confirm the plan, secure the first phase-gate, and issue the data request for the next component.

Output of this step: Approved engagement plan; next component mobilized.

Tools, analyses & frameworks

- Everything in the Business X-Ray SOP (seven-lens diagnostic, Aperture Score, Theory of Constraints).
- Success-measure definition (turn goals into trackable KPIs).
- Engagement sequencing / phase-gate planning.

Quality checklist (before readout)

- ☐ The constraint is agreed with the owner in writing.
- ☐ Success measures are specific, baselined, and trackable.
- ☐ Each downstream component has its data prerequisites listed.
- ☐ Phase-gate dates and decision criteria are set.

Readout & handoff

With the baseline set and the sequence agreed, hand off to the first prescribed component — most often Aperture Analytics. Carry the success measures forward; they become the Scoreboard KPIs in Atlas.

03 · Aperture Analytics™

Quantify “Why is it happening?” · Deliverable: Profit Map™ + scenario model

Segment: 02 · Quantify **Deliverable:** Profit Map + forward-looking scenario model

Typical duration: 3–4 weeks **Owner:** Senior lead (Fenwick How)

Objective

Show exactly where the business makes and loses money — by product/service, location, and customer — and turn the financials into the handful of profit drivers the owner can actually move. Build a scenario model so decisions can be tested before they’re made.

When to run it & prerequisites

Run after Insights, when the constraint is financial or when the owner needs to know which moves pay off most.

Inputs required

- Detailed revenue and cost data — ideally transaction- or job-level.
- Chart of accounts and cost allocations (or enough to build them).
- Volume/units by product, service, location, and customer.
- Any pricing, discount, and membership structures.

The deliverable produced

- A Profit Map — profit by product/service, location, and customer segment.
- The true cost structure and contribution margins.
- The 80/20 profit drivers — the few levers that matter.
- A scenario & forecast model to test decisions (e.g., fix retention vs. open a location).

Step-by-step process

Step 1 — Build the financial model

Assemble revenue and costs into a clean model that reconciles to the P&L.

- Allocate shared costs on a defensible basis.
- Compute contribution margin at the finest level the data allows.

Output of this step: Reconciled profitability model.

Step 2 — Map profitability

Cut profit by product/service, location, and customer segment to see where it concentrates and where it leaks.

- Identify loss-making or margin-diluting segments.
- Separate the engine (what carries the business) from the drag.

Step 3 — Run the 80/20 & cost-structure analysis

Find the small set of drivers responsible for most of the profit, and the costs quietly eroding it.

Output of this step: Ranked profit drivers and leaks.

Step 4 — Break-even & sensitivity

Establish break-even points and test how sensitive profit is to price, volume, cost, and mix.

Output of this step: Sensitivity ranges for key levers.

Step 5 — Build the scenario / forecast model

Model the real choices on the table over a 3-year horizon so options can be compared on profit, cash, and risk.

- Parameterize the key drivers.
- Compare the strategic options quantitatively.

Output of this step: Interactive scenario model.

Step 6 — Synthesis & readout

Explain, in plain terms, where the money is and the two or three moves that most improve it. Recommend, and secure the phase-gate.

Output of this step: Prioritized financial moves; gate decision.

Tools, analyses & frameworks

- Profitability & contribution-margin analysis.
- Cost-structure and cost-allocation analysis.
- 80/20 (Pareto) driver analysis.
- Break-even & sensitivity analysis.
- Regression / forecasting for revenue and cost drivers.
- Scenario modeling (multi-year, driver-based).

Quality checklist (before readout)

- ☐ The model reconciles to the client's financials to the dollar.
- ☐ Cost allocations are documented and defensible.
- ☐ Profit cuts are shown at the level the data actually supports (no false precision).
- ☐ The scenario model's assumptions are explicit and adjustable.
- ☐ Recommendations tie back to the #1 constraint.

Readout & handoff

Feed the profit drivers and the shortlisted moves into Aperture Compass for scoring. Where a move is spatial (where to grow, which location), hand off to Aperture Intelligence first.

04 · Aperture Intelligence™

Reveal “What opportunities does it reveal?” • Deliverable: Customer & Market Map™ + GIS package

Segment: 03 · Reveal **Deliverable:** Customer & Market Map + ArcGIS layer package

Typical duration: 2–3 weeks **Owner:** Senior lead (Fenwick How)

Objective

Show who the best customers are, where they are, and where the next ones will come from — the client's market, customers, and competitors laid over real geography. Answer, with evidence, “where do we grow next?”

When to run it & prerequisites

Run when the opportunity is spatial: site selection, trade-area growth, targeting, or expansion decisions.

Inputs required

- Customer records with addresses or ZIP codes (and transactions if available).
- Location list for the client's sites.
- Known competitor locations (or we source them).
- Any market/marketing spend by area.

The deliverable produced

- A Customer & Market Map — patients/customers mapped, trade areas, and demand clusters.
- Customer segments and lifetime value.
- Competitive and market-penetration benchmarks.
- A site-selection / where-to-grow recommendation.
- A load-and-go ArcGIS layer package the client keeps.

Step-by-step process

Step 1 — Assemble & geocode customer data

Clean and geocode customer records; de-identify once mapped.

- Standardize and validate addresses.
- Geocode, then drop street-level PII for analysis.

Output of this step: Geocoded, de-identified customer layer.

Step 2 — Customer analytics

Segment customers and compute lifetime value to know who the best ones are before mapping where they are.

Output of this step: Segments + CLV by segment.

Step 3 — Trade-area & drive-time analysis

Define trade areas and drive-time rings around each location; measure where demand concentrates.

- Build primary/secondary trade areas.
- Overlay demographics (age, income, households, spend).

Output of this step: Trade areas + demand concentration.

Step 4 — Market penetration & competition

Measure penetration by area and map competitors to find contested and open demand.

Output of this step: Penetration + competitive map.

Step 5 — Site-selection modeling

Score candidate areas for the next location or focus, using demand, gaps, demographics, and competition.

- Rank ZIPs/areas by opportunity score.
- Name the strongest untapped area(s).

Output of this step: Ranked site-selection model.

Step 6 — Build the ArcGIS package & readout

Assemble the layer package with recommended symbology and a layer guide, and present the 'where to grow' answer.

Output of this step: GIS package delivered; gate decision.

Tools, analyses & frameworks

- GIS / spatial analysis (ArcGIS).
- Geocoding & address validation.
- Trade-area & drive-time modeling.
- Demographic & human-data overlays (age, sex, income, households, spend).
- Customer segmentation & lifetime value.
- Site-selection & market-penetration modeling.
- Competitive benchmarking.

Quality checklist (before readout)

- ☐ Geocoding accuracy checked; unmatched records reported, not hidden.
- ☐ PII removed from the analysis layer after geocoding.
- ☐ Trade areas and drive-times use documented, sensible parameters.
- ☐ The growth recommendation is backed by the client's own demand data.
- ☐ The ArcGIS package opens cleanly with the layer guide.

Readout & handoff

Pass the ranked opportunities and the growth recommendation into Aperture Compass for scoring and sequencing against every other option.

05 · Aperture Compass™

Navigate “Where should we go next?” · Deliverable: Opportunity Matrix™ + Focus Plan™

Segment: 04 · Navigate **Deliverable:** Opportunity Matrix + Now/Next/Later Focus Plan
Typical duration: 1–2 weeks **Owner:** Senior lead (Fenwick How)

Objective

Turn everything the earlier phases surfaced into a prioritized, board-ready plan. Score every opportunity on value, complexity, risk, and impact; rank them; and sequence the winners into a clear order of operations.

When to run it & prerequisites

Run after Analytics and/or Intelligence, once there is a real set of opportunities to weigh.

Inputs required

- The shortlisted moves from Analytics (profit drivers) and Intelligence (growth options).
- The #1 constraint and success measures from Insights.
- Owner’s constraints — capital, capacity, risk appetite, timing.

The deliverable produced

- An Opportunity Matrix — every option scored on value, complexity, risk, and impact.
- A defensible ranking of the options.
- A Now / Next / Later Focus Plan with owners and milestones.

Step-by-step process

Step 1 — Consolidate the opportunity set

Gather every candidate move from prior phases into one list, de-duplicated and clearly defined.

Output of this step: Master opportunity list.

Step 2 — Score in the weighted decision matrix

Score each option against the standard criteria with agreed weights.

- Value / return.
- Complexity / effort.
- Risk / confidence.
- Impact on the #1 constraint.

Output of this step: Scored, weighted matrix.

Step 3 — Stress-test against scenarios

Test the top options against the Analytics scenario model and plausible futures so the ranking is robust.

Output of this step: Scenario-tested ranking.

Step 4 — Sequence into Now / Next / Later

Order the winners so the constraint is addressed first and expansion follows only when the numbers support it.

- Assign an owner and milestones to each.

- Note dependencies and gates.

Output of this step: Sequenced roadmap.

Step 5 — Build the Focus Plan & readout

Package the matrix and roadmap in a board-ready format and present. Secure sign-off to execute (and, typically, to move to Atlas).

Output of this step: Approved Focus Plan.

Tools, analyses & frameworks

- Weighted decision matrix (standard criteria & weights).
- Scenario stress-testing (using the Analytics model).
- Roadmapping (Now / Next / Later with owners and milestones).
- Prioritization against the binding constraint.

Quality checklist (before readout)

- ☐ Every opportunity is scored on the same criteria and weights.
- ☐ The ranking is reproducible and the weights are recorded.
- ☐ The sequence puts the constraint first; expansion is gated on evidence.
- ☐ Each item has an owner, milestones, and dependencies.
- ☐ The plan is genuinely board-ready — one page tells the story.

Readout & handoff

Hand the Focus Plan to execution and to Aperture Atlas — its initiatives and success measures become the live Scoreboard.

06 · Aperture Atlas™

Perform “How do we sustain and improve results?” · Deliverable: Scoreboard™ + KPI system (ongoing)

Segment: 05 · Perform **Deliverable:** Live Scoreboard + KPI system on the Aperture Platform
Typical duration: Ongoing (stand-up ~2–3 weeks, then recurring) **Owner:** Senior lead (Fenwick How)

Objective

Keep the strategy live. Stand up an always-on executive Scoreboard of the few KPIs that matter, wired to the client’s systems and powered by the Aperture Platform (SyncPoint AI), and run the cadence that keeps the plan honest — quarter after quarter.

When to run it & prerequisites

Run after Compass, at the end of the arc, to sustain results and prove progress. Atlas is the recurring engagement.

Inputs required

- The Focus Plan and its success measures.
- Live connections to the client’s systems (accounting, POS, CRM, marketing).
- The Aperture Score baseline from Insights.
- Agreed owners and cadence.

The deliverable produced

- A live executive KPI dashboard (the Scoreboard) the client keeps.
- Automated reporting on a set cadence.
- A re-scored Aperture Score each period to prove progress.
- A running steering cadence (monthly) and review (quarterly).

Step-by-step process

Step 1 — Define the KPIs

Select the few KPIs tied to the success measures and the constraint. Fewer, better.

- Definition, source, target, cadence, and owner for each.
- Red/amber/green thresholds.

Output of this step: Approved KPI definitions.

Step 2 — Wire the data

Connect the client’s systems to the platform with least-access, automate the feed, and validate the numbers against source.

- Build the data pipeline into the Aperture Platform.
- Reconcile dashboard values to source systems.

Output of this step: Live, validated data feed.

Step 3 — Build the Scoreboard

Assemble the dashboard: KPIs against targets, trends, and the Market Map/forecast where relevant. Powered by SyncPoint AI.

Output of this step: Published Scoreboard.

Step 4 — Set the cadence

Stand up automated reporting and the meeting rhythm — monthly steering, quarterly review.

- Assign KPI owners.
- Schedule reporting and reviews.

Output of this step: Operating cadence live.

Step 5 — Re-score & steer

Each period, re-score the Aperture Score, review progress on live data, and re-open the next constraint. It's a loop, not a line.

Output of this step: Proven progress; next constraint identified.

Tools, analyses & frameworks

- The Aperture Platform (Geographic Intelligence & BI), powered by SyncPoint AI.
- KPI design & red/amber/green tracking.
- Data integration / pipelines (least-access).
- Automated reporting.
- Aperture Score re-scoring (before/after proof).

Quality checklist (before readout)

- ☐ Every KPI has a definition, source, target, owner, and cadence.
- ☐ Dashboard numbers reconcile to the source systems.
- ☐ Access is least-privilege and documented.
- ☐ The re-scored Aperture Score uses the identical baseline method.
- ☐ The client can operate the Scoreboard themselves — it's theirs to keep.

Readout & handoff

Atlas is the durable end-state. Fresh data re-opens the next constraint and can trigger a new component engagement — the loop restarts. Confirm the recurring agreement (from the contract) is in place.